Springfield M1903 / M1903A3

Springfield Armory / Rock Island / Remington / Smith-Corona • U.S. Rifle, Caliber .30, Model of 1903 (.30-06 Springfield)

Manufacturer:	Springfield Armory / Rock Island / Remington / Smith-Corona	**Category:**	Rifles & Carbines
Action Type:	Modified Mauser Controlled Round Feed Bolt Action	**Era / Service:**	American Military Standard (1903–1945+)
Calibers:	.30-06 Springfield (M1906 / M2 Ball)	**Covered Models:**	M1903 Standard (Ladder Sight), M1903 Mark I (Pedersen Device Cut), M1903A3 (Aperture Receiver Sight), M1903A4 Sniper Rifle

KEY ARMORER TASKS & BENCH OPERATIONS

Core Procedures: Low-Number Receiver Metallurgy Safety Verification • Magazine Cut-Off Switch Detent Service • Two-Piece Firing Pin Rod Assembly • Coned Breech Headspace Checking • Stock Recoil Lug Bedding

CRITICAL ARMORER TOLERANCES & SPECIFICATIONS

SPECIFICATION / CLEARANCE	ARMORER TOLERANCE & BENCH SPECIFICATION
LOW NUMBER WARNING	CRITICAL ARMORER SAFETY WARNING: Low-number receivers (Springfield Armory under serial # 800,000; Rock Island under # 285,507) were single heat-treated case-hardened steel and prone to brittle shattering. DO NOT shoot heavy modern ammunition in low-number rifles
HIGH NUMBER RECEIVERS	Double heat-treated (Springfield 800,000–1,275,767) and Nickel steel (above 1,275,767; all Remington and Smith-Corona 1903A3s) are 100% safe for standard service ammunition
MAGAZINE CUTOFF	Three-position thumb lever (ON: feeds from internal 5-round magazine; OFF: magazine locked in reserve for single-shot loading; MID: allows bolt removal)

IMMEDIATE ACTION & MALFUNCTION DIAGNOSTIC MATRIX

MALFUNCTION CONDITION	PROBABLE CAUSES	ARMORER BENCH REMEDY
Stoppage 1: Bolt Will Not Pull Back Out of Receiver for Cleaning Shooter pulls bolt handle rearward to remove bolt, but it hits a positive mechanical stop	• Magazine cutoff lever is set in ON or OFF position instead of center horizontal REMOVE position.	**Immediate Action: Look at left rear of receiver. Flip magazine cutoff lever to the exact center horizontal position (halfway between ON and OFF). Pull bolt straight back out of receiver.**

CURATED BENCH VIDEO REFERENCES

PROCEDURE TITLE	INSTRUCTOR / CREATOR	TECHNICAL PROCEDURE SUMMARY
Springfield M1903 Complete Disassembly & Low-Number Safety	Brownells Gunsmithing Bench	Teardown of the 1903 Springfield: examining serial number ranges for metallurgy safety, two-piece firing pin service, and tuning the magazine cutoff.